

PTI PHOTO



CINEMATIC SPORT

In the bat versus box office battle, it seems a blend of sporty style and star power will now make a winning combination for advertisers. A popular liquor brand has cashed in on this strategy and brought Twenty20 champs **Mahendra Singh Dhoni**, **Yuvraj Singh**, **Harbhajan Singh** and **Robin Uthappa** as well as Bollywood star **Saif Ali Khan** together in the same commercial. So if you are still debating whether film stars or sports heroes sell, the two together seem to work magic. That is, till the disciplined sports heroes have to encounter tinsel town's famous tardiness. Cheers.

POP PUNCH

Punjabi pop star **Daler Mehndi's** latest musical composition, attacking the previous Congress regime and singing paeans to Chief Minister Parkash Singh Badal, has struck a political note. Mehndi landed the punches at his first stage show in Punjab since he was booked in a human trafficking case four years ago, calling it a "regime of dacoits and goondas". Congress has rubbished this as a "crude attempt" to get himself bailed out of a sticky situation. Clearly, the balle balle man is trying to strike the right chord.



AP PHOTO/PETER DEJONG

Back to School

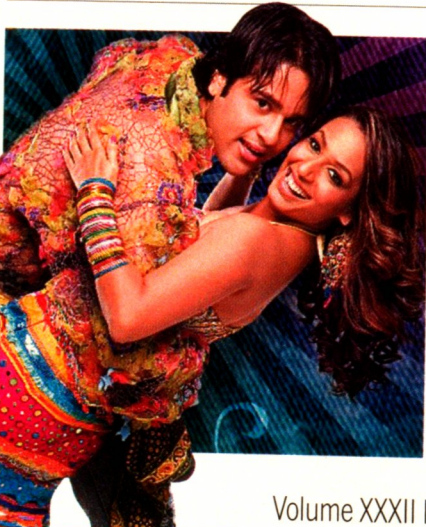
It was back to school for **Brinda Karat** when she returned to Welham Girls as chief guest for their 50th anniversary bash. And even 45 years later, all the old lessons were intact. Karat said it was this school that taught her to be fiercely independent. While we can't help thinking that was aimed at some of the cabinet ministers who studied at the nearby Doon School, she also criticised the **Dosc**os for quoting **Elvis Presley** in love letters instead of a more literary source. Are the **Dosc**os in her family listening?

■ Compiled by
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Vote Lost

With her seductive moves and his dancing genes, starlet **Kashmera Shah** and actor Govinda's nephew **Krushna Abhishek** were poised to take *Nach Baliye 3* by storm. And now the duo's ouster from the show, due to lack of audience votes, has surprised everyone including Shah. Shocked that the audience "did not support talent", Kash-Krush will now "rise from the dust" in the wild card round. Perils of public voting or a TRP stunt? Vote now.



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CRUNCH
CRUNCH
CRUNCH

Whatever it is,
say it with a crunch.

